You can vary this dish by substituting smoked pork sausage for pancetta or using duck instead of chicken. You may wish to add a little filé powder, if you have it.

chicken and pork gumbo

SERVES 6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1½ HRS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS WITHOUT THE RICE

2 chicken leg and thigh portions
7oz (200g) diced pancetta
2 boneless belly pork slices, rinded and diced
1 quart (1 liter) chicken stock
1 bay leaf
2 red bell peppers
2 tbsp butter
1 onion, chopped
1 garlic clove, chopped
1 celery rib, sliced
3 tbsp flour
2 beefsteak tomatoes, peeled and chopped
2 tbsp tomato purée
4oz (115g) thin green beans, trimmed and cut in short lengths
5½oz (150g) okra, cut in short lengths
2 large sprigs of fresh thyme, chopped, plus a little extra to garnish
2 tsp sweet paprika
1 tsp smoked paprika
1 tsp brown sugar
a few drops of Tabasco
salt and freshly ground black pepper
8oz (225g) long-grain rice, cooked

1 Put the chicken, pancetta, and pork slices in a saucepan with the stock and bay leaf. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer gently for 1 hour. Meanwhile, roast the peppers under a broiler for 10–15 minutes until blackened. Put in a plastic bag, let cool, then peel off the skin, discard the stalks and seeds, rinse, and dice the flesh.

2 Strain the stock through a sieve and set aside. Lift the chicken out of the sieve and place on a board. Remove all the meat from the bones and cut into small pieces, discarding the skin. Add to the pork and set aside.

3 Melt the butter in the pan. Cook the onion, garlic, and celery for 2 minutes, stirring. Stir in the flour and cook for 3 minutes, stirring, until golden. Remove from the heat and blend in the stock. Return to the heat and bring to a boil. Add the remaining ingredients except the meat and rice. Bring back to a boil, reduce the heat, partially cover, and simmer for 30 minutes. Stir in the meats, taste and season with Tabasco, salt, and pepper. Remove the bay leaf. Spoon the rice into bowls, ladle the gumbo over, and garnish with thyme.